

How do submarines work?

A submarine does not float on the water like a boat. It travels below the surface, filling and emptying large tanks with water or air to allow it to dive and rise. The submarine shown here travels at depths of about 1,600 ft (500 m).

In a spin.....

Jets of steam spin turbines in the engine room. The turbines drive a propeller at the back of the sub, which pushes it through the water.

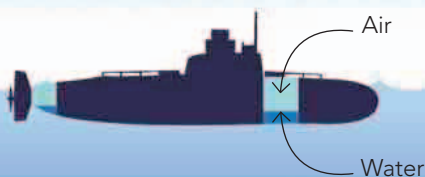
Nuclear power.....

This submarine's engine is powered by nuclear energy. The energy produces heat, which makes the steam that drives the turbines.

Sleeping space.....

The sub's crew sleeps in cramped bunk beds. They work in shifts throughout the day and night.

Going down... and coming back up



Staying afloat The submarine's tanks are filled with air. This allows it to float on the surface of the ocean.



Going down When the sub needs to dive down water is pumped into the tanks, replacing the air.



Rising up The sub will rise to the surface again if the water is pumped out and air is pumped in.